

This step-by-step guide will help you prepare your dog for import into Australia from a Group 3 classified country.

You can print this guide and use it as a checklist.

Need to know

This is a complex process. Before you start the import process, we recommend you read this guide in full.

- Allow at least 6 months to complete health checks, tests and paperwork.
- All procedures must be completed by a government approved veterinarian in an approved country.
- Fees apply for our services, such as permit assessment and quarantine in Australia.
- There are certain breeds of dog that are prohibited from import to Australia.
- Overseas travel can cause stress to animals. If your dog is sick or elderly, consider if this is the right decision for them.

1

We encourage you to use an experienced pet transport agent or shipper.

Importing a dog to Australia is a complex process. It will take at least 6 months to complete. You will need to make sure your dog meets a range of import conditions. This includes multiple veterinary visits, checks and treatments.

Seek help from a pet transport agent with experience in importing dogs to Australia. They will help guide you through the import process.

To find a pet transport agent or shipper you can:

- search online (use terms like ‘pet transport agent Australia’)
- check the [International Pet and Animal Transportation Association \(IPATA\)](#).

We cannot recommend one agent over another. We have no influence over any fees or charges an agent may require for their services.

This is an optional step, but we recommend you use an agent.

2

You must meet all import conditions before you can bring your dog to Australia.

Check if this is the right guide for you

This step-by-step guide is for dogs exported from Group 3 countries. These are approved countries of origin for dog imports into Australia. Group 3 countries have rabies present, but it is well controlled

Check the list of Group 3 countries to make sure this is the right guide for you.

- Antigua & Barbuda
- Argentina
- Austria
- Bahamas
- Belgium
- Bermuda
- Brunei Darussalam
- Bulgaria
- Canada
- Cayman Islands
- Chile
- Croatia (Republic of)
- Cyprus (Republic of)
- Czechia (Czech Republic)
- Denmark (including Greenland)
- Estonia
- Finland
- France
- Germany
- Gibraltar
- Greece
- Guernsey
- Hong Kong
- Hungary
- Ireland (Republic of)
- Isle of Man
- Israel
- Italy
- Jamaica
- Jersey
- Kuwait
- Latvia
- Liechtenstein
- Lithuania
- Luxembourg
- Macao
- Malta

- Monaco
- Montenegro
- Netherlands
- Northern Mariana Islands
- Norway
- Poland
- Portugal
- Puerto Rico
- Qatar
- Reunion
- Saint Kitts & Nevis
- Saint Lucia
- Saint Vincent & the Grenadines
- Serbia
- Seychelles
- Slovakia
- Slovenia
- South Africa (Republic of)
- South Korea (Republic of)
- Spain (including Canary and Balearic Islands)
- Sweden
- Switzerland
- Taiwan
- Trinidad & Tobago
- United Arab Emirates
- United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
- United States of America (excluding Guam and Hawaii)
- Uruguay
- Virgin Islands (British)
- Virgin Islands (United States of America)

Your country of export is not on the Group 3 list. [Find the right step-by-step guide](#) for your animal and country of export.

If your dog is coming from a Group 3 country, continue through this guide.

Confirm your dog is eligible for import to Australia

You must import your dog to Australia from an approved country (includes Group 3 countries).

To be eligible, dogs residing in a Group 3 country must:

- have lived in an approved country for at least 180 days before export (from the date the RNATT sample arrives at the laboratory)
- meet specific conditions related to rabies vaccination and testing.

We cannot give advice on treatments for diseases. Seek advice from a veterinarian if your dog tests positive to an infectious disease.

The 180 days in an approved country is NOT a quarantine period.

Your dog can be living with you or someone else in an approved country while being prepared for export. They must complete a period of quarantine after arriving in Australia.

When you plan to export your dog, it must NOT be:

- under quarantine restrictions
- more than 30 days pregnant
- nursing puppies.

Some dog breeds are not allowed into Australia.

This includes some hybrid dogs (domestic and non-domestic) and some pure-bred dogs.

These bans relate to environmental protection and customs laws. They are not biosecurity laws. You will need to talk to the relevant government agency for details.

Hybrid dogs NOT allowed into Australia include:

- Czechoslovakian wolfdog or Czechoslovakian Vlcak
- Saarloos wolfdog or Saarloos wolfhound
- Lupo Italiano or Italian wolfdog
- Kunming wolfdog or Kunming dog.

Contact the Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water at Exotic.Species@dcceew.gov.au. They can provide more advice on hybrid animals.

Pure breed dogs banned from Australia include:

- dogo Argentino
- fila Brasileiro
- Japanese tosa
- American pit bull terrier or pit bull terrier
- Perro de Presa Canario or Presa Canario.

Contact the Department of Home Affairs on +61 2 6264 1111 or 131 881 (within Australia) for more on prohibited dog breeds.

Mixed-breed dogs are allowed if the dog meets all other import conditions.

If an imported dog is identified as possibly being a prohibited breed after arrival in Australia, the Department of Home Affairs may investigate further.

If your dog is sick or old

Consider your dog's age and general health.

Sick and elderly animals do not cope with long distance travel and climatic stress.

We do not recommend importing sick or very old animals. International travel can cause them to destabilise and rapidly deteriorate. Even dogs with well-managed chronic diseases can arrive in distress and poor health.

Animals may be unable to get medication during transport. As a pet owner, you must consider if it's in your pet's best interests to travel the long distance and stay in quarantine.

Seek advice from the competent authority in your export country

How to find the competent authority in your country.

A competent authority is the government agency responsible for animal health. This may be a government veterinary service or similar. In Australia, it is us (Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry).

The competent authority must provide official documents, for your dog before it leaves for Australia. We check these when your dog arrives in Australia to ensure your dog has undergone the required pre export veterinary procedures.

When you contact them, confirm they are recognised by us to oversee all veterinary checks and issue required documents.

All pre-export veterinary procedures must be completed:

- by a government approved veterinarian
- in an approved country
- before departing for Australia.

This process ensures your dog doesn't bring diseases to Australia.

When you talk to the competent authority in your country, they will let you know:

- any local procedures or requirements you must meet before you export your dog
- how to find approved laboratories for pre-export testing.

We rely on the competent authority to identify which vets can prepare dogs for export in their jurisdiction. In many countries, this may simply be a registered veterinarian. In some countries, it may be specific vets. Contact the competent authority to check local requirements.

Don't risk arriving in Australia with the wrong checks, treatments or certificates.

Talk to the competent authority. Only use a government approved veterinarian to prepare your dog for export.

Export conditions can vary between countries. The competent authority and approved vet can advise you on extra steps you need to take that aren't in this guide or detailed on your import permit.

Read through this guide

We recommend you read this whole guide before you start the import process.

This guide details important actions you must take. This includes applying for and being issued with an import permit. Your import permit outlines the exact preparations required for your dog. You must meet all these conditions before you bring your dog to Australia.

Share this guide and your import permit with your approved veterinarian and pet transport company. They will help you meet all conditions.

The import process takes time.

Make sure you're aware of how far ahead of export date you need to start each step. This will be covered in more detail in your import permit.

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Do this before you start the import process and at least 180 days before export.

Check your dog has a microchip or implant a new one

Microchips are the only approved identification method. The competent authority in the export country will use the microchip to verify your dog's identity.

A [government approved veterinarian](#) must scan the microchip:

- at each visit
- before any pre-export blood sampling.

They will check that the microchip number is recorded on all documentation.

Your dog must be implanted with a microchip that is ISO compliant. Generally, microchips with 10 or 15 digits are ISO compliant.

Microsoft numbers starting with 999 are not accepted because they are not unique.

It is essential your dog has a working microchip before you start the import process.

The government approved veterinarian must scan your dog's microchip at each veterinary visit and accurately record this on all documents including test samples. This is how we match your dog to its preparations and documents.

We do not accept changes to laboratory reports or other documents to include or amend the microchip.

If a microchip cannot be read or is incorrect in your documents, your dog cannot be imported to Australia.

If your dog has 2 compliant microchips

Both compliant microchip numbers must be included on:

- the import permit application
- all laboratory reports
- the veterinary health certificate
- the RNATT declaration
- the identity check (if performed).

Both microchips must be scanned and recorded at each veterinary visit. They must match all import documents.

If your dog has a compliant microchip and a non-compliant microchip, we will only use the compliant microchip.

If your dog's microchip stops working

The veterinarian should try multiple microchip scanners to read the microchip. An X-ray can be used to locate the microchip if it has moved from the implant site.

Your dog must arrive in Australia with a microchip that can be scanned and linked to the import permit, health certificate and laboratory reports.

Confirm your dog's identity

This is an optional step that can reduce the time your dog will need to stay in quarantine in Australia from minimum 30 days to minimum 10 days.

Your dog's identity can only be verified by the competent authority in an approved country, before any other pre-export preparations. Ask them to verify your dog's identity so you can import your dog to Australia. Most countries have a specific template.

Do this before having blood taken for the Rabies Neutralising Antibody Titre test (RNATT). An identity check cannot be done at the same vet visit as the RNATT. The identity check document is provided by an official veterinarian only and provided directly to us.

A pet passport, vaccination card or microchip certificate are not accepted as equivalent.

Identity declarations are valid for as long as the animal:

- can be identified by the verified microchip on the declaration, and
- resides in an approved country.

Do this at least 180 days before export AND before taking blood for the RNATT.
For dogs less than 6 months old, get their identity verified before you start the import process.

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Your dog must be rabies free and vaccinated against rabies to be exported to Australia.

You must complete all rabies requirements before you apply for an import permit.

Find a government approved vet

All veterinary preparations must be done by a government approved veterinarian.

To find an approved veterinarian or laboratory, contact the competent authority in the export country. This is the government veterinary service or equivalent.

Any testing must also be done by a laboratory approved by the competent authority in the country of export. Your vet can help you with this.

Vaccinate your dog against rabies

Your dog must maintain a valid rabies vaccination status from the date of the RNATT to the date of export.

If your dog's vaccination status lapses, it is ineligible for export. Your dog will need to be vaccinated again. A new RNATT sample must then be collected. The 180-day waiting period would be restarted.

The government approved veterinarian must use an approved rabies vaccine. This vaccine must be:

- given when the dog was at least 84 days old
- valid continuously from the RNATT ([step 4.3](#)) up to and including the date of export
- approved for use in dogs by the competent authority of the country of export.

Rabies vaccines that are valid for 3 years are acceptable if given according to the manufacturer's instructions.

See [more on rabies vaccination](#).

Wait 3-4 weeks between the rabies vaccination and the date a blood sample is taken for the RNATT.

If your dog has regular rabies vaccinations, you may be able to collect the blood sample sooner. Check with your veterinarian.

Arrange a rabies neutralising antibody titre test (RNATT)

Your dog cannot be exported to Australia for at least 180 days after the RNATT sample arrives at the laboratory.

There are no exceptions to this mandatory 180-day waiting period. This is a residency period. It is not a quarantine period.

The RNATT is a blood test that checks if your dog has developed protection against rabies from the vaccinations it was given. This means it must be completed after rabies vaccination.

A government approved veterinarian must:

- scan the dog's microchip
- collect the blood sample for the RNATT.

This must be done in an approved country.

Your dog's microchip number must be written accurately on the blood tube and the laboratory submission form.

Plan the timing of the RNATT sample.

The RNATT sample must be taken between 12 months and 180 days before the date of export.

Your dog must already be vaccinated. Dogs that are regularly vaccinated may not need to wait 3-4 weeks. Check with your vet. If it's the first time they are vaccinated, you will need to wait 3-4 weeks before getting the RNATT.

If your dog receives a rabies vaccine valid for 3 years, the RNATT can likely be performed any time in that 3-year period. If the result is too low, a repeat vaccination and repeat RNATT will be required.

The RNATT blood sample can be sent to a laboratory in another approved country.

The laboratory used must be recognised by the government of the country of export.

About the test

The RNATT blood sample can be taken in an approved country and tested at a recognised laboratory in another approved country.

The testing laboratory must use either:

- fluorescent antibody virus neutralisation (FAVN) test, or
- a rapid fluorescent focus inhibition test (RFFIT).

A result of 0.5 IU/ml or more is acceptable.

A result of less than 0.5 IU/ml is not acceptable. You must re-vaccinate and repeat the RNATT.

Make sure your dog's RNATT remains valid up until the date of export.

An RNATT is valid for 12 months or 365 days from the date of blood sampling. The validity period of your import permit will be in line with your dog's RNATT.

If it is close to expiring, you must have your dog retested. The blood sample must arrive at the laboratory within 12 months of the original sample. You will then need to [apply to have your import](#)

[permit varied in BICON](#) to extend the validity of your import permit. If you do this, you will avoid restarting the 180-day waiting period before export.

If the RNATT is more than 12 months old at the time of export, it's not valid and you cannot export the dog to Australia. You must have your dog retested. You will also have to wait at least 180 days after this second test sample arrives at the laboratory.

Laboratory report

You must have a laboratory report showing the results of the RNATT.

The laboratory report must be in English and completed on the testing laboratory's letterhead. It must include:

- your dog's microchip number
- blood sampling date and location
- signature of the person issuing the laboratory report
- test type
- test result.

RNATT laboratory reports with an e-signature and QR code are acceptable.

We will not accept laboratory reports where the microchip number, collection date or result has been corrected.

Get the RNATT declaration

Request an RNATT declaration from the competent authority in your country of export.

Most countries have a specific template that the official government veterinarian will be able to provide you. The department will only accept the country-specific RNATT declaration negotiated with approved trading partners.

An official government veterinarian must complete, sign, and stamp the RNATT declaration.

You will need to submit to them:

- rabies vaccination certificate
- RNATT laboratory report

The microchip number, test result and blood sampling date must be the same on the RNATT laboratory report and RNATT declaration. Even a one number difference could cause delays in the import process.

Make sure that the RNATT laboratory report and RNATT declaration state the name of the testing laboratory, not the submitting laboratory. Ask your vet if you are unsure.

See more on [rabies vaccine and testing requirements](#).

The official government veterinarian is not the veterinarian that prepared your dog for export. Check with the competent authority in your country of export. They can tell you who will need to complete the RNATT declaration.

You must provide a copy of the RNATT laboratory report and declaration when you apply for an import permit.

You may also need to provide previous RNATT laboratory reports and corresponding RNATT declarations. This is needed if your pet has more than one RNATT.

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Allow plenty of time to get your permit before your proposed export date.

Apply for a permit as soon as you can after the RNATT declaration.

Permits can take time to be issued. Most permits are issued in 20-40 business days. It can take up to 123 business days in some cases.

Apply for an import permit

When you apply for an import permit, you must provide:

- a copy of the RNATT laboratory report issued by the testing laboratory
- the corresponding RNATT declaration, endorsed by the official government veterinarian employed by the competent authority.

This applies to all cat and dog imports from Group 3 countries.

If you did not include the required rabies documents when you applied for an import permit, provide them to us now.

If you have not applied for an import permit, make sure you include them.

How to apply

Apply for your import permit through our Biosecurity Import Conditions System (BICON).

Be aware that applying for an import permit does not guarantee you will be issued with one.

Import permits are valid until the Rabies Neutralising Antibody Titre Test (RNATT) expires. This is 12 months from when the blood sample was collected.

Pay in full when you submit your application in BICON.

Extra charges may apply if information is missing, incorrect, or if an application is put on hold.

Your import permit is NOT issued.

We may require more details from you before we can issue a permit. We'll advise you of further action you can take to meet import conditions. In rare cases, we may refuse to issue an import permit.

Your import permit is issued.
Continue through the steps in this guide.

Meet all import permit conditions

Read your import permit carefully. It includes important conditions you must meet such as required post-entry quarantine period.

If your permit is issued, you must make sure you meet all your import permit conditions.

The conditions will be specified on the permit. This includes specific pre-export veterinary procedures required for your dog. These conditions are mandatory.

Make sure you read all import permit conditions and understand what you need to do.

If you fail to comply with your permit conditions, your dog may be:

- held longer in post entry quarantine
- subject to additional testing
- exported
- euthanised.

You will be liable for any costs involved.

The import permit must be valid on the date your dog arrives in Australia.

The import permit will be valid until the Rabies Neutralising Antibody Titre test (RNATT) expires (12 months from the date the blood sample was taken).

To extend the validity of your import permit, you will need to repeat the RNATT process.

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Do this after you receive your import permit.

Book your dog's post-entry quarantine stay

Your dog will stay at least 10 days in quarantine in Australia.

Dogs must spend at least 30 days at the Mickleham post entry quarantine facility. Our quarantine facility is designed to comfortably accommodate dogs and meet their needs.

This period of quarantine can be reduced to at least 10 days if:

- an official government veterinarian verified your dog's identity before taking blood for the RNATT (see [Step 3.2](#)), or
- your dog originated in Australia and has evidence of their identity on their Australian-issued export certification.

Check rules for stops on the way to Australia

We have specific rules for travel that include stops in other countries.

These rules depend on whether your dog will:

- remain on the plane (transiting)
- be unloaded from the plane and moved to another plane (transshipping).

Make sure you understand these rules when choosing flights.

Transiting

During transport to Australia dogs may transit in all countries. This means the plane can touch down in a country, but your dog must stay on the plane on international side of the airport.

Transshipping

Your dog may tranship (change aircraft) in any approved country on their way to Australia.

Your dog must not leave the international side of the airport. It must stay under the supervision of the competent authority in the country of transshipment. It must be in a place that restricts contact with other animals.

It is your responsibility as the importer to contact the competent authority in the country of transshipment. You will need to find out:

- whether they allow animals to tranship
- whether they have a facility to hold animals during transshipment
- how long the animals can be held
- if additional conditions apply.

Your dog may not be eligible for import if these conditions are not met.

Consider your dog's travel arrangements

We cannot control how long your dog will be held at these destinations. If your dog is sick or elderly, consider if this is the right decision for them.

Book travel for your dog

You can make the travel arrangements yourself or use an animal transport company.

You can use any airline to transport your dog to Australia, at the airline operator's discretion. Find a list of animal transport companies on the [International Pet and Animal Transportation Association \(IPATA\) website](#).

Your dog must arrive directly to Melbourne International airport. We do not permit domestic transfers (e.g. arrival into Sydney airport and domestic flight to Melbourne).

Your dog must travel:

- as manifested cargo (not in the cabin)
- in an International Air Transport Association (IATA) approved crate.

We are not responsible for your dog while they are under the care of the aircraft operator.

You must pay all transport costs for your dog.

Chartered or private aircraft

If your dog will arrive in Australia by chartered or private aircraft, please download and read our advice.

[Cats and dogs arriving by chartered or private aircraft \(PDF 159 KB\)](#) [Cats and dogs arriving by chartered or private aircraft \(DOCX 230 KB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#) for assistance.

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These must be completed by a government approved veterinarian in an approved country.

Check all timings of tests and treatments as soon as possible.

Plan early. You need to make sure you complete all treatments and tests in the correct timeframes before export.

All preparations are calculated from the date of export, local time in the country of export. For calculating timeframes, the date of the treatment or preparation counts as 'day 0'.

Complete all remaining veterinary preparations

All veterinary preparations must be done by a government approved veterinarian.

Any testing must also be done by a laboratory approved by the competent authority in the country of export.

You can use the same government approved vet that completed your dog's rabies testing and vaccinations.

We cannot give advice on treatments for diseases. Seek advice from a veterinarian if your dog tests positive to an infectious disease listed in the import conditions.

We recommend you share this step-by-step guide and your import permit with your approved vet.

Your vet will help you make sure you meet all import conditions. This information is also useful to share with pet transport companies.

Guidance for vets

You can also download and share our guidance for vets:

Check vaccinations

Vaccination requirements vary depending on the country your dog is coming from.

Leptospira canicola (leptospirosis) vaccination or testing

All dogs coming to Australia from a group 3 country require either:

- to be vaccinated against *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola OR
- tested negative for *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola (leptospirosis). See [Step 7.3](#) for advice on the test option.

If you choose to vaccinate, your dog must be fully vaccinated against *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola, according to manufacturer's recommendations. This is usually:

- a course of 2 vaccines, 2-4 weeks apart
- yearly boosters administered at the interval specified by the manufacturer to maintain immunity.

The vaccination must be valid in accordance with the manufacturer's directions at the time of export.

The annual revaccination (booster) or final vaccination of the primary course must be administered between 12 months and 14 days before export to Australia.

Guidance for vets

You can also download and share our guidance for vets on *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola:

For USA and South Korea only

Dogs from the United States of America (USA), the Republic of South Korea must be fully vaccinated against Canine influenza (CIV) for import to Australia.

Make sure your vet uses a CIV vaccine that is:

- registered for use in dogs in the country of export
- effective against the CIV virus strains in the area where the dog has been living.

Allow enough time to complete the primary course following the registered manufacturer's directions

For previously unvaccinated dogs, the primary course must be completed at least 14 days before export to Australia.

For dogs with a history of regular CIV vaccinations, their vaccination status must be valid per the manufacturer's directions at the time of export. This means following the primary course, the dog has

received booster vaccinations as specified by the manufacturer to maintain immunity. The booster must be given between 12 months and 14 days before export to Australia.

For Canada only

Dogs coming from Canada to Australia must:

- be fully vaccinated against CIV, or
- undergo isolation and testing for CIV.

If a dog undergoes isolation and testing, they must have:

- A health certificate from the government approved veterinarian that states:
'I have no reason to doubt the declaration provided by the owner/exporter, that the dog described in this certificate has been isolated from other dogs and has not had direct contact with other dogs (unless those dogs are part of the same export shipment) for the 10 days immediately preceding the date of export to Australia.'
- a negative test for CIV by polymerase chain reaction on a nasal or deep pharyngeal swab collected within 7 days prior to export
- an examination within 48 hours of export and found to be free from clinical signs of infectious or contagious disease.

Recommended vaccinations

This is an optional step.

We recommend that your dog is vaccinated against:

- Distemper
- Hepatitis
- Parvovirus
- Para-influenza
- Bordetella bronchiseptica.

These diseases exist in Australia. Vaccination is not mandatory.

Check when your dog was last vaccinated.

Vaccinations should be valid for the entire post-entry quarantine period.

Test for *Leptospira canicola* (leptospirosis)

This step only applies if your dog is not vaccinated against *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola. See [Step 7.2](#) for advice on the vaccine option.

An approved veterinarian must:

- scan and verify your dog's microchip

- collect and test a blood sample using a microscopic agglutination test (MAT).

The test must produce a negative result.

If your dog returns a positive result, you must contact us for advice. Further testing and treatment may be required. This may delay your dog's export.

Test for *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola within 45 days of the date of export.

Test for *Brucella canis* (brucellosis)

This step only applies if your dog is not desexed.

To be considered desexed:

- female dogs must have undergone ovariohysterectomy or bilateral ovariectomy
- male dogs must have undergone bilateral orchiectomy.

Evidence of desexing may be requested by the competent authority in the country of export. We may also request evidence.

If your dog is not desexed, a government approved veterinarian must scan and verify the animal's microchip and collect a blood sample to test for *Brucella canis*.

The blood sample must be tested using 1 of these methods:

- a rapid slide agglutination test (RSAT), or
- a tube agglutination test (TAT), or
- an indirect fluorescent antibody test (IFAT).

The test must produce a negative result.

Some laboratories refer to the TAT as a serum agglutination test (SAT). This test type is also accepted.

Ensure you use the correct test type

Please note that Australia will only accept the following tests as valid for *Brucella canis*:

- Indirect fluorescent antibody test (IFAT)
- Tube agglutination test (TAT)
- Rapid slide agglutination test (RSAT).

Only the standard versions of these tests will be accepted. Any alternative test not listed above will require further clarification before they can be considered.

Tests which are NOT approved include the 2ME-RSAT, 2ME-TAT, AGID / AGID II, Canine Brucella Multiplex Assay and Brucella Slide Agglutination / AGID II combination test.

Test for *Brucella canis* (brucellosis) within 45 days of the date of export.

Pregnant, mated or artificially inseminated dogs must meet strict timeframes.

The test sample must be collected within 45 days of the date of export. Your dog must not be mated or artificially inseminated within 21 days before blood sample collection for the Brucella canis test. After the test sample is collected, the dog cannot be mated or artificially inseminated before the date of export, regardless of pregnancy status. Pregnant dogs can only be imported to Australia if no more than 30 days pregnant.

To meet these timings, you must:

- only mate or artificially inseminate a dog within 30 days of export
- then collect the test sample for Brucella canis at least 21 days after the most recent mating/insemination date
- then not mate or inseminate the dog from test sample collection until export to Australia
- ensure the test sample is collected within 45 days of export.

This means that if the mating results in a pregnancy, there is a small window in which the test sample can be collected, laboratory results returned, and the dog exported to Australia while less than 30 days pregnant.

Test for Leishmania infantum (leishmaniosis)

A government approved veterinarian must scan and verify your dog's microchip. They must collect and test a blood sample using 1 of these methods:

- an indirect fluorescent antibody test (IFAT), or
- an enzyme linked immunosorbent assay (ELISA).

The test must produce a negative result.

Ensure you use the correct test type

Please note that Australia will only accept the following tests as valid for Leishmania infantum:

- An indirect fluorescent antibody test (IFAT), or
- An enzyme linked immunosorbent assay (ELISA)

Only the standard, quantitative versions of the above tests will be accepted. 'Rapid' or 'snap' versions of these tests are not acceptable.

Test for Leishmania infantum (leishmaniosis) within 45 days of the date of export.

Treat for external parasites

A government approved veterinarian must treat your dog with an acceptable product that kills ticks and fleas on contact. The chosen product must remain effective against new flea and tick infestations until the date of export to Australia.

The veterinarian may need to repeat to maintain protection until export. They must follow the manufacturer's directions.

At each visit after the treatment has started, the veterinarian must examine the dog for external parasites. If fleas or ticks are found they must be removed, and the treatment restarted.

See [acceptable external parasite treatments](#).

Start at least 30 days before export and repeat according to manufacturer's directions.

To calculate 30 days before the date of export, count the first day of treatment as day 0. For example, if treatment is given on 1 January, then the earliest date of export is 31 January.

Treat for internal parasites

A government approved veterinarian must treat your dog for nematodes and cestodes (internal parasites).

See [acceptable internal parasite treatments](#).

Plan enough time to complete these before you export

Your dog must be treated twice within 45 days before export. The two treatments must be spaced at least 14 days apart. The second treatment must be given within 5 days before the export date.

For example, if the date of export is 30 January:

- The earliest date the first treatment can be given is 16 December.
- The earliest date the second treatment can be given is 25 January.

There are more than 14 days between 16 December and 25 January – this meets the 14-day spacing requirement.

Ask your vet about products that cover both nematodes and cestodes.

Combined products that cover both nematodes and cestodes are available in many countries.

Time saver.

It's acceptable to do the final vet check and second internal parasite treatment at the same vet visit.

If your dog has visited mainland Africa

If your dog has ever visited mainland Africa, a government approved veterinarian must treat your dog internally with imidocarb dipropionate.

Dosages are either:

- a single dose at 7.5 mg/kg body weight, or
- 2 doses at 6.0 mg/kg body weight given 14 days apart.

Treatments must be given by subcutaneous injection.

Treatment must be given within 28 days of the date of export.

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These are the final preparation activities before you export your dog.

Book a pre-export clinical examination

Your dog must be examined for external parasites and clinical signs of infectious or contagious disease. A government approved veterinarian or official government veterinarian must do this.

You must bring these documents to the examination:

- a valid import permit
- RNATT laboratory report
- Leishmania infantum laboratory report
- Brucella canis laboratory report (if not desexed)
- Leptospira interrogans serovar Canicola laboratory report or vaccination certificate
- Canine influenza virus vaccination certificate (if required)
- a copy of the veterinary health certificate for the government approved vet to complete at this visit. You'll need to get a blank copy from the competent authority in the country of export.

Within 5 days before your dog's export date.

It's acceptable to do the second internal parasite treatment at the same vet visit as the final vet check.

Get your approved vet to complete the veterinary health certificate

The veterinary health certificate is an agreed document between the department and your competent authority. You will need to get a blank copy from your competent authority.

The approved vet completing your dog's preparations will then complete the certificate.

Get your documents endorsed by an official veterinarian

Take the completed health certificate and laboratory test reports to the competent authority for endorsement by an official government veterinarian in the country of export.

An official government veterinarian must:

- complete, sign and stamp all pages of the veterinary health certificate (endorsement)
- sign and stamp each document as required on your permit that is travelling with your pet (e.g. RNATT laboratory report).

Any corrections to the veterinary health certificate must be struck through. Corrections must be legible and signed and stamped by the official government veterinarian. Do not use correction fluid.

An official government veterinarian must also sign and stamp every page of the:

- RNATT laboratory report
- Leishmania infantum laboratory report
- Brucella canis laboratory report (if not desexed)
- Leptospira interrogans serovar Canicola laboratory report (if not vaccinated).

Within 5 days before your dog's export date.

For example, if the date of export is 30 January, the earliest date the health certificate can be endorsed is 25 January. The certificate must be endorsed after the final veterinary health check and second internal parasite treatment has been completed. These can both be completed on the same day.

Check competent authority office hours and timeframes.

Government offices may be closed over local public holidays and weekends. You will need to make sure that you have enough time to get the veterinary health certificate endorsed before export.

Gather your import documents

Send all import documents with your dog.

A valid import permit, health certificate and relevant documents must travel to Australia with your dog. Keep a copy of each document for your records.

Your dog must arrive in Australia with these documents:

- a valid import permit
- a veterinary health certificate
- laboratory test reports and vaccination certificates relevant to each import requirement
- RNATT declaration.

The health certificate must be an original document. Copies will not be accepted.

Each page of the veterinary health certificate and laboratory reports must bear the original ('wet ink') stamp of the competent authority. It must also be signed and dated by the endorsing official government veterinarian of the competent authority.

Only the first page of the import permit needs to be endorsed.

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What to do when you're ready to send your dog, and what will happen when they arrive.

Prepare your dog for travel

Your dog must arrive in Australia before your import permit expires (when your RNATT expires).

On the day of travel:

- Place your dog in an [International Air Transport Association \(IATA\) approved crate for dogs](#).
- Do not place any items, including toys, medication or items of value, in the crate (these will be destroyed as biosecurity waste upon arrival).
- Pet transport agents can assist you with how to prepare the crate, for example how to attach water containers.

In most cases, you will check your dog in at the freight terminal, not the passenger terminal.

Check with your airline to find out which terminal you need to use.

When your dog arrives in Australia

One of our biosecurity officers will collect your dog on arrival. They will transport your dog to the Mickleham post entry quarantine facility.

You will be notified via email that your animal has arrived safely, within 24 hours of arrival. We will contact you immediately if there is an issue with your animal on arrival.

We'll help your dog settle in and get comfortable after its flight. We will check your dog to make sure they're healthy and free from diseases or pests of biosecurity concern. We'll assess your dog's import documents to check your dog complies with our import conditions.

Your dog will be housed in a large, individual, climate-controlled enclosure. They'll be fed quality food and provided with enrichment. We will give you updates on your dog's health and wellbeing via email.

Read more about our state-of-the-art [quarantine facility](#).

If your dog does not comply with the permit conditions, further tests, treatments or quarantine may apply.

Dogs must stay at Mickleham for a minimum of 30 days, unless your dog is eligible for the minimum 10 day stay.

Any issues that increase biosecurity risk may result in a longer stay.

Register your dog in Australia

You are responsible for meeting any local requirements for dogs in Australia.

Contact your local Australian council or government. They can tell you what you must do. This might include registering your dog and their microchip and paying yearly fees.

We are not involved in local council and national microchip registration databases.